

MARKETING MIX (4Ps)

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From STP to Marketing-Mix

STP

- Who we serve?
→ Segmentation & Targeting
- How will we create value for them?
→ Differentiation & Positioning
“We are a **fast** delivery company”
“**90%** of our deliveries reach customers **within 30 minutes**”

Marketing – **Mix: work together**

- What we offer?
→ Product
- What customers give up?
→ Price (benefit + value)
- How customers obtain it?
→ Place (Distribution + Time)
- How we communicate value?
→ Promotion

The 4Ps: at a glance

PRODUCT

Variety
Quality
Design
Features
Brand
Packaging
Services

Eg: Apple iPhone:
Premium smartphone:
ecosystem, design,
camera, iOS, etc.

PRICE

List price
Discounts
Allowances
Payment terms
Credit terms

Eg: Apple iPhone:
premium pricing

PLACE

Channels
Coverage
Locations
Inventory
Logistics

Eg: Apple iPhone:
Apple Stores,
authorised retailers,
telecom operators,
online channels

PROMOTION

Advertising
Sales promotion
Personal selling
PR

Digital/direct
marketing
Eg: Apple iPhone:
Product launches,
digital communication,
advertising,
influencer/media
coverage

PRODUCT



What Is A Product?

A product is anything that can be offered to a market for attention, acquisition, use or consumption that might satisfy a want or need.

A product can be a good, service, experience, event, person, place, organisation, or idea.



Goods

Example: Car



Services

Example: Medical check-up



Experiences

Example: Travel



Events

Example: Football match



Persons

Example: Celebrity / public speaker



Places

Example: Paris



Organisations

Example: Charity or university

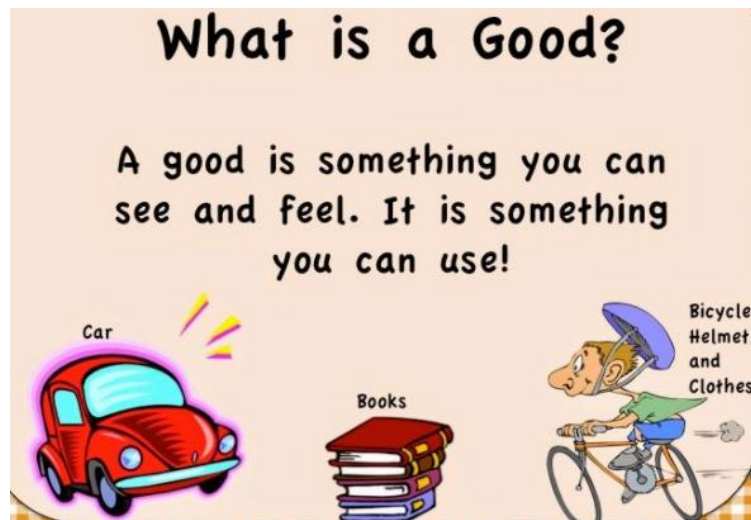


Ideas

Example: Go green

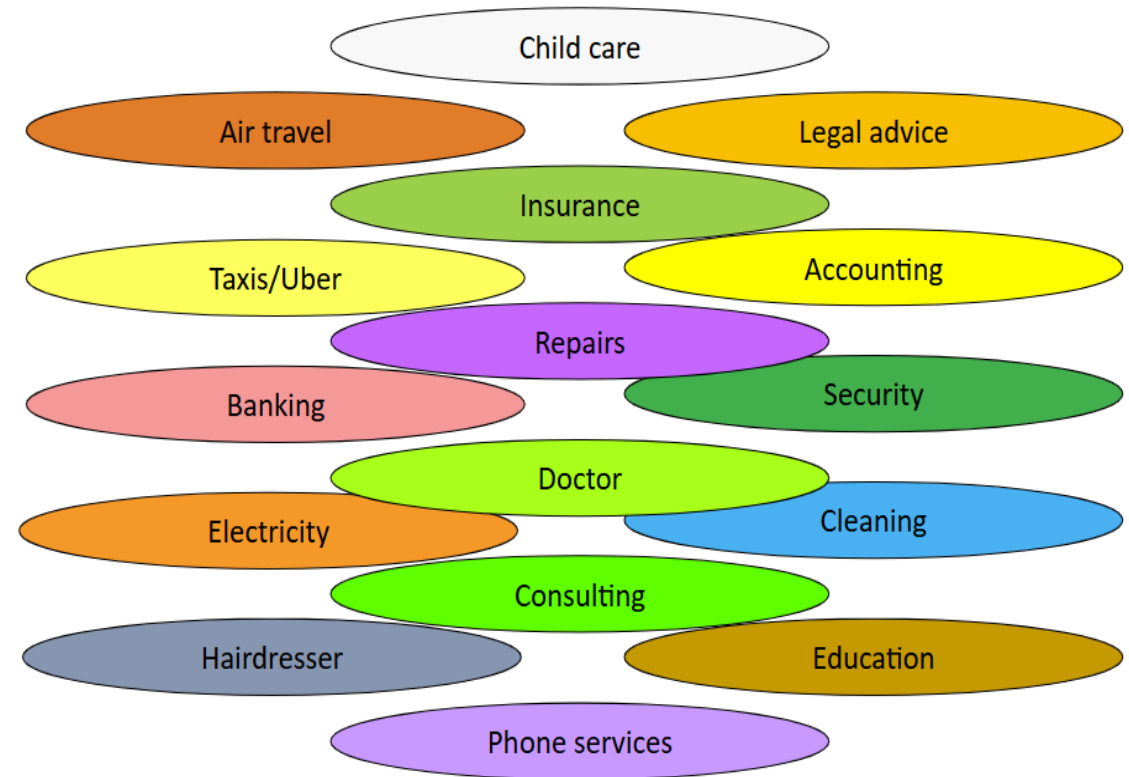
Product: Goods vs. Services

- A product is anything that can attract market attention and be consumed, purchased, or exchanged to satisfy consumers' needs and wants.
- A service is a type of product whose value to consumers is determined primarily by the benefits it provides rather than by physical ownership.



Service characteristics

- **Intangibility**
 - Cannot be seen, touched, or physically examined before purchase
 - Customers often have to **trust** the provider
 - Cannot usually be “tested” in advance
- **Inseparability**
 - Production and consumption often occur at the same time
 - The service provider and customer may both be part of the service experience
- **Variability**
 - Service quality can vary
 - It may depend on who provides the service, when, where, and how
- **Perishability**
 - Services cannot be stored or inventoried for later use
 - Production and consumption must therefore be coordinated in the right sequence and at the right time



A Trip to Kyoto as a Total Market Offering

A Kyoto trip combines many market offerings, not just one experience.

1

Services



Airline seat, hotel room, train ticket, guided tour

2

Goods



Souvenirs, snacks, travel items

3

Places



Kyoto as a destination

4

Persons



Tour guide, hotel staff, local people

Overall Experience: Travel to Kyoto



5

Events



Festivals, seasonal events

6

Organisations



Airline Hotel Railway Museum Tourism Office
Airline, hotel, railway, museum, tourism office

7

Ideas



Cultural heritage Sustainability Hospitality
Cultural heritage, hospitality, sustainability

8

Experience



Sightseeing, learning, memorable moments

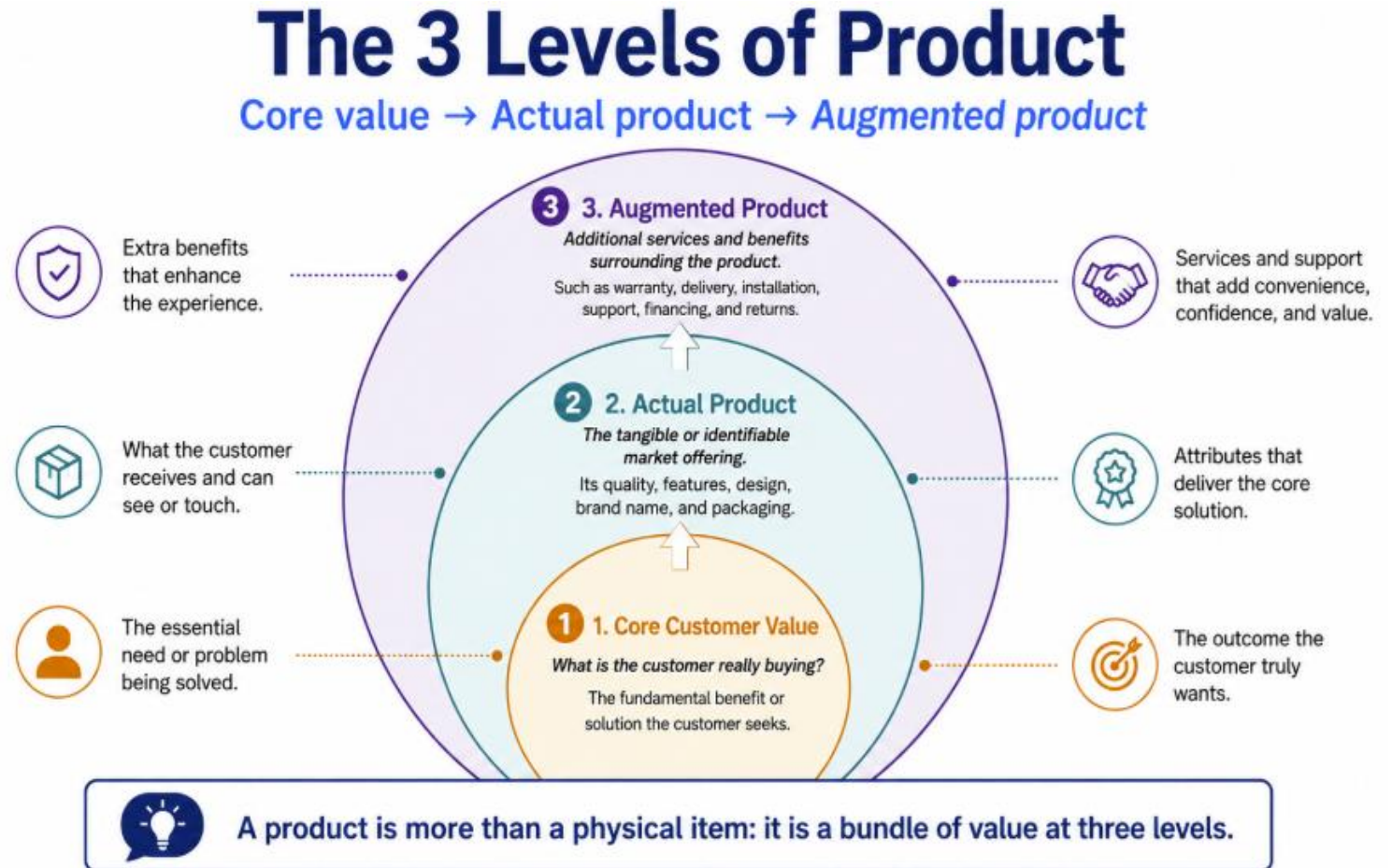


Discussion:

Which components are goods, services, persons, places, events, organisations, ideas, and experiences?

THREE LEVELS OF PRODUCT

- **1. Core Customer Value**
- What is the customer really buying?
- **2. Actual Product**
- The tangible or identifiable market offering.
 - Quality level
 - Features
 - Design
 - Brand name
 - Packaging
- **3. Augmented Product**
- Additional services and benefits surrounding the product
- Warranty, Delivery, Installation, Customer support, Financing, Returns, App/software support, Loyalty programmes



A Kyoto trip can be analysed as a core benefit, an actual product, and an augmented product.

2 Actual Product

The actual trip package and destination elements the customer receives.

-  Airline seat
-  Hotel room
-  Train ticket
-  Guided tour
-  Kyoto destination
-  Temples / shrines
-  Festivals
-  Local food
-  Sightseeing attractions



3 Augmented Product

Additional services and benefits that enhance the trip.

-  Booking support
-  Travel app / online booking
-  Customer service
-  Itinerary planning
-  Airport transfer
-  Reviews / information
-  Tourism office help
-  Safety / assistance
-  Memorable photo sharing

Question:

- Analyse the 3 levels of a university degree
- Which level creates the greatest differentiation between universities? For example: A Business Administration program at HUST and at NEU

A University Degree Through the 3 Levels of Product

Core value → Actual product → Augmented product



Hints: Differentiation comes from **how the programme is designed and what the additional value is.**

Actual level: Curriculum, lecturers, specialisations, teaching approach, university reputation

Augmented level: Internships, industry links, exchange opportunities, alumni network, career support

PRODUCT CLASSIFICATIONS:

Consumer vs. Industrial Products

- Consumer vs. Industrial Products: B2C and B2B marketing
- **Consumer Products**
 - Purchased by final consumers for personal consumption.
 - **Convenience products**
 - **Shopping products**
 - **Specialty products**
 - **Unsought products**
- **Industrial Products**
 - Purchased for:
 - further processing,
 - producing other products,
 - or conducting a business.
- Eg: A laptop bought by:
 - Student → consumer product
 - Company for employees → industrial product

Convenience Products

- Products consumers usually buy:
 - Frequently
 - Immediately
 - With minimum comparison and effort
- Eg: Bottled water, snacks, toothpaste, basic household items
- **Marketing implications**
 - Relatively low price
 - Wide distribution
 - Easy availability
 - Mass promotion
- Eg: Coca-Cola needs to be available almost everywhere customers might want a drink.

Shopping Products

- Consumers compare alternatives based on:
 - Suitability
 - Quality
 - Price
 - Style
- Eg: Furniture, Clothing, Electronics, Hotels, Cars
- **Marketing implications**
 - Selective distribution
 - More information
 - Greater salesperson/customer interaction
 - Product differentiation becomes important

Specialty Products

- Products with: Unique characteristics & Strong brand identification
- Customers are willing to make **special purchasing effort**.
- Eg: Ferrari, Rolex, Luxury designer handbags, Certain specialist cameras
- Customers often do not compare many substitutes.
- **Marketing implication:** Brand identity and exclusivity matter more than distribution intensity.

Unsought Products

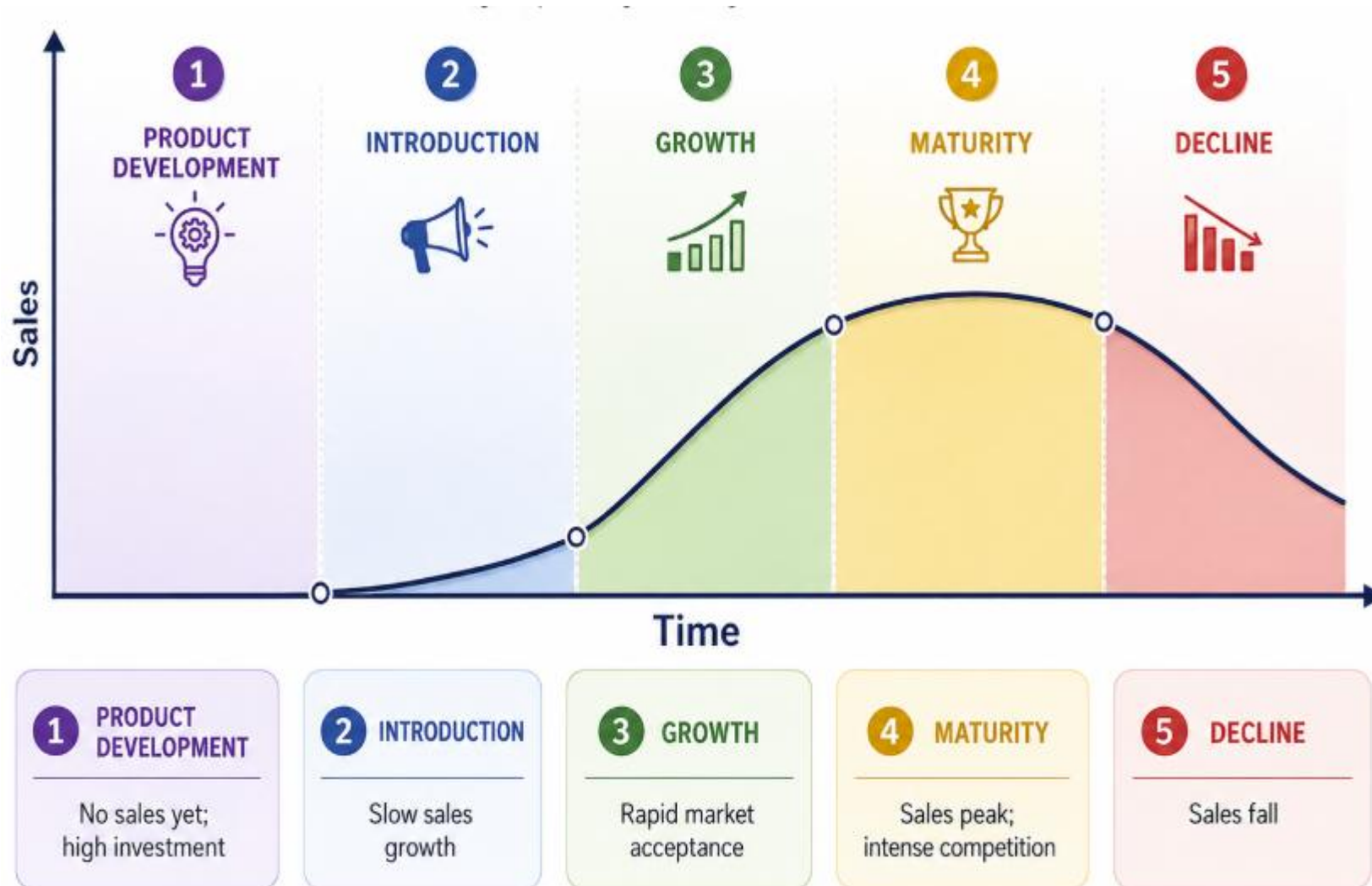
- Products consumers:
 - Do not know about, or
 - Normally do not think of buying.
- Eg.: Funeral services, Certain insurance products, Emergency medical products
- **Marketing implication:** They often require:
 - Strong awareness building
 - Personal selling
 - Education
 - Persuasive communication

BCG Growth–Share Matrix

Product Portfolio Analysis



Product Life Cycle (PLC)



- **Development:** no sales yet; investment costs are high
 - **Introduction:** sales grow slowly; profits are usually low or negative
 - **Growth:** sales rise rapidly; profits increase
 - **Maturity:** sales growth slows; competition becomes intense
 - **Decline:** sales and profits fall
- Companies need new products because:
- Customer needs change
 - Technology changes
 - Competitors innovate
 - Existing products decline
 - New market opportunities emerge

PRODUCT DECISION

Product Quality

Product Features

Product Design



Product Quality

- **Quality Level:** The level of performance appropriate for the target market.
- **Quality Consistency:** Delivering the expected level of performance consistently.
- **Higher quality does not always mean “the best possible quality.”**
- Eg: A budget hotel does not need golden bathrooms, but customers still expect:
 - cleanliness,
 - safety,
 - and consistency.

Product Features

- A basic product can be offered with different features → Features can help:
 - Differentiate a product
 - Target different segments
 - Support different price levels
 - Increase customer value
- **Eg: Cars**
- Basic model:
 - Standard engine
 - Manual controls
- Higher version:
 - Advanced safety
 - Larger screen
 - Premium audio
 - Driver assistance
 - Leather interior

Product Design and Style

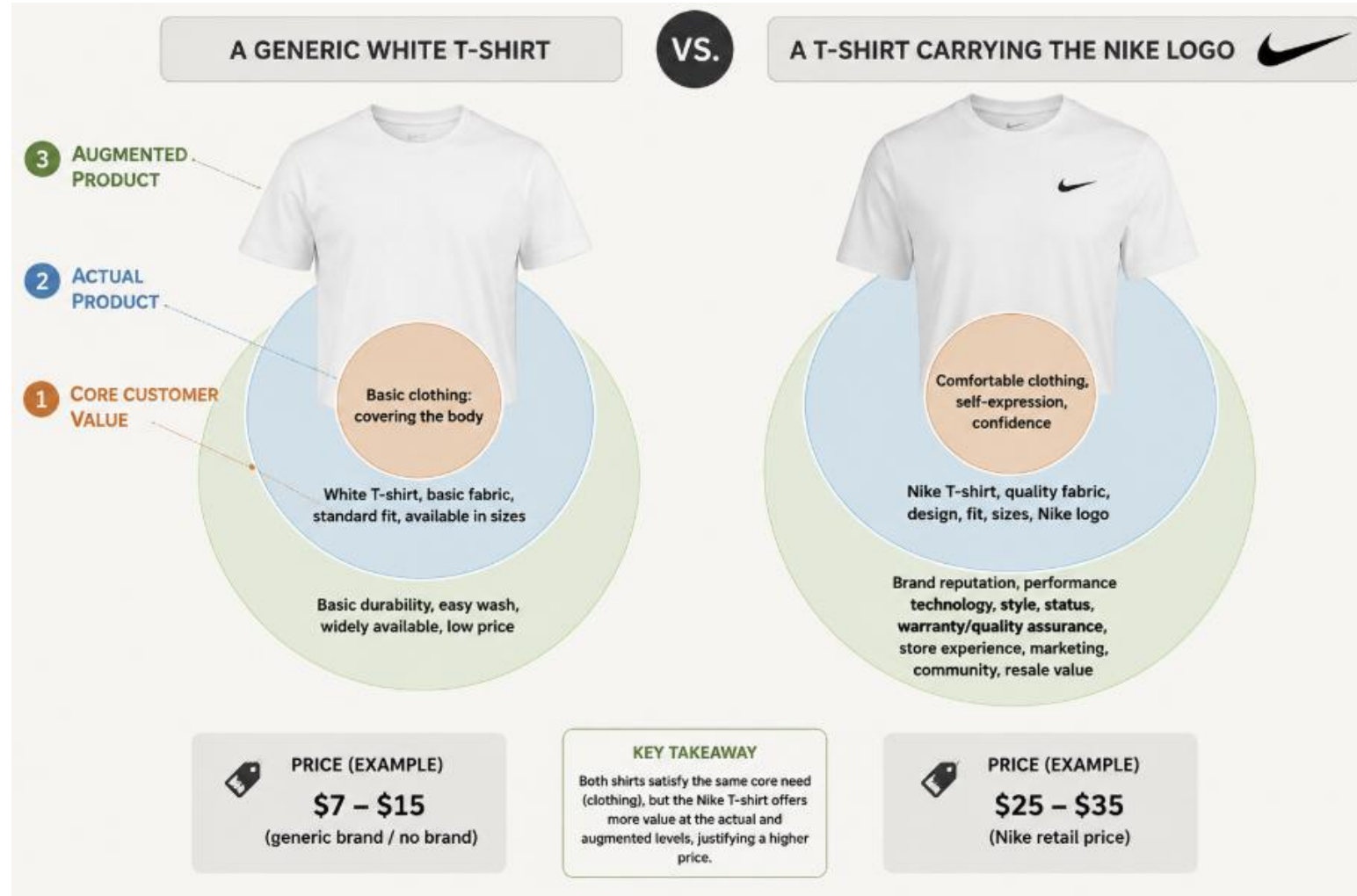
- **Style** describes the **appearance** of a product.
- **Design** contributes to both appearance and usefulness/performance.
- Good design begins with observing customer needs, not only making a product look attractive

Dyson competes through product innovation rather than price alone.



BRANDING

- A brand is more than a name or logo. It represents consumers':
 - Perceptions
 - Experiences
 - Expectations
 - Associations
 - Relationships with the Product
- Brands can help
 - Identify products
 - Reduce search effort
 - Reduce perceived risk
 - Signal expected quality
 - Express identity
 - Build trust



BRAND NAME

- A strong brand name should ideally be:
 - Memorable: Nike, Apple, Grab
 - Distinctive: Sunkiss, Google, Qantas
 - Easy to pronounce: Heineken vs. Carlsberg
 - Appropriate to the product: Cocoon, Sunsilk, Head & Shoulder
 - Extendable: Vinhomes, VinMec, VinFast, Vinmart, VinEdu
 - Legally protectable: Kodak, Bvlgari
 - Suitable across markets
- **International challenge:** Names can carry different:
 - meanings,
 - pronunciation,
 - associations
 - across countries.

Coca-Cola in China: Brand Name Localisation

When Coca-Cola entered China in the late 1920s, some **local sellers created phonetic Chinese renderings** of “Coca-Cola” before the company had established an official Chinese brand name. Some combinations of characters sounded roughly like Coca-Cola but produced absurd meanings such as “**bite the wax tadpole**” or similar nonsense.

The Coca-Cola Company later selected 可口可乐 (Kěkǒu Kělè), which preserves a reasonably similar sound while carrying positive associations roughly along the lines of “**tasty/pleasant to the mouth**” and “**happiness**.”

蝌 蚪 啃 蜡
Kē dòu kěn là
=
“Bite the wax tadpole”
(nonsense / negative meaning)

可口可乐

Kěkǒu Kělè
(Coca-Cola)



可口 (kěkǒu) — pleasant / tasty / agreeable to the mouth

可乐 (kělè) — happiness / enjoyment / pleasure

A successful international brand name must consider both sound and meaning, as well as cultural associations in the target market.

Chevrolet Nova

When Chevrolet introduced their car **Nova** to Spanish-speaking markets, people later joked that the name sounded like the Spanish phrase “**no va**” — “**it doesn’t go.**” This became a famous marketing story: imagine trying to sell a car whose name seems to say that it cannot move.

PACKAGING

- **Packaging: More Than a Container**
- Packaging traditionally protects the product.
- Today it can also:
 - Attract attention
 - Communicate positioning
 - Differentiate brands
 - Provide convenience
 - Communicate information
 - Support brand recognition
- Packaging as a Marketing Tool: shapes perceived value before the product is even used



Reduce, Reuse and Recycle Package

Current packaging strategies commonly focus on **Reduce, Reuse and Recycle**, including lighter packaging, recycled content, refill systems, reusable containers, recyclable mono-materials, and, where appropriate, compostable or bio-based materials.

- **Less material** — smaller, lighter packaging
- **Recycled materials** — recycled paper, glass or plastic
- **Recyclable design** — easier for consumers to sort and recycle
- **Reusable / refillable packaging** — refill pouches, returnable bottles, refill stations
- **Renewable or bio-based materials** — where environmentally appropriate
- **Minimal unnecessary packaging**

Eg: the EU's new Packaging and Packaging Waste Regulation generally began applying on **12 August 2026** and aims to reduce unnecessary packaging, increase reuse, and improve recyclability

In Vietnam, many F&B sellers have shifted from conventional plastic takeaway containers to alternatives such as **sugarcane-bagasse boxes, paper packaging, biodegradable bags, and other plant-based materials**. Eg: Central Retail Vietnam has piloted food trays and packaging made from biodegradable sugarcane bagasse, and Vietnamese F&B businesses have also adopted eco-friendly takeaway packaging

Labelling

- Labels may:
 - Identify the product
 - Describe the product
 - Provide instructions
 - Communicate ingredients
 - Provide safety information
 - Support brand positioning
 - Meet legal requirements
- Eg: Food labels:
 - Nutrition information
 - Ingredients
 - Allergens
 - Origin
 - Expiry date

Team work



Questions:

- Analyse the 3 levels of your business case study
- Which levels can be use to compete on the market?
- Any suggestions for the Product decision?